RPA adoption potential by buyer industry and function (Source: www.uipath.com)

formats (docs, pdfs, etc) with existing accounting systems. Common processes such as generating bank statements, KYC, loan processing, and invoice processing become much faster and more accurate.

Marketing. This sector mostly involves variable activities that lead to a complexity to define RPA, sometimes even requiring AI. Tasks that can be streamlined include business intelligence reporting, digital ad positioning, basic sales procedures, and more.

HR. Be it talent search, hiring and onboarding, employment history authentication, or absence of management, a lot of time is consumed in going through the same time-sensitive processes over and over again. Understandably, it becomes more of a pain point as the number of employees increases. Although new, a growing number of companies are deploying RPA tools in the HR department due to their quick implementation.

Retail. This is another sector where most of the processes like tracking shipments, shipping products, updating orders, among others can be automated. The bots can read and consolidate the required information easily. Hence, the bottlenecks related to returns and other complaints can be readily resolved.

Other industries like insurance and manufacturing can also benefit from RPA. Talking about the implementation of RPA in manufacturing, Sirisha says, "The advent of robotic process automation (RPA) has always been a key milestone for the manufacturing industry. RPA allows manufacturers to streamline operations and reduce managerial processes' complexities, thus creating a more agile system. As a technology company, we have always believed in technology's power—be it in the products we manufacture or in-house processes. We have implemented various Industry 4.0 practices at our plants, including a certain amount of automation across multiple levels. So, transformation to RPA was a natural step for us."

Also, implementing automation based on departments instead of processes leads to duplication. For example, if both the HR and legal departments need the same list, there should be a single logic implementation.

Should you invest in RPA?

The economic crisis from Covid-19 has caused a sudden surge in RPA as businesses are looking for a cost-effective alternative to fill the workforce gap due to the shortage of employees. But as a senior decision-maker, the last thing you would want is losing money. If there is a lack of data or the process is already obsolete, RPA cannot be a beneficial option. Successful automation is not just about having the latest tech tools but about understanding the current technology of your business and strategising beforehand.

It's not just large organisations but also small to medium-sized businesses (SMBs) and small and mid-sized enterprises (SMEs) that are looking for new ways to get the work done efficiently. Although there would be more users doing the same work in large organisations, it is difficult for SMBs to retain talented employees.

Manish says, "Most businesses face pressures of new technologies, growth, customer expectations, cost pressure, technology and process optimisation, outsourcing, market saturation, and compliance and regulation. Yet, their core priorities stay the same, to increase revenue and lower costs, improve customer satisfaction, increase employee engagement, and reduce compliance risk. In a large organisation's automation journey, there would be a full-fledged team required to take care of both the